

say always will be with us. It is not to be treated as an absolute, for the value of money keeps changing.

By and large, however, one great absolute remains: Within the context of his times, a man's services are worth as much as he gives. Most men of fifty or more years of age can look back upon their pattern of income from jobs and see that this is so.

Moreover, we instinctively know this and we show we know it. I cherish a story told me by Henry Ford which illustrates the point beautifully.

During the early days of the business which is now so big, Mr. Ford advertised for a general sales manager. He weeded out the applications and interviewed some of the more promising prospects. In talking to one man, he finally got down to discussing salary. They did not seem able to fix a sum, so Mr. Ford said: "Suppose you come in and show us what you can do for a month, then we'll pay you all you are worth."

"No," said the applicant, "I'm getting more than that where I work now."

"And," Mr. Ford chuckled, "subsequent events proved that with his slip of the tongue he spoke the truth. At the end of the first month, we had to fire him."

I do not know why Mr. Ford hired the man, but presumably he appeared to have the experience and other qualities needed for the job. Then it turned out that the appearance of giving was all he had to give—and the reward was commensurate.

You cannot fake the Golden Rule. Does the Golden Rule, then, apply even in cases of hiring and firing? I shall not say this is invariably the case, but on the long average—yes, it does apply. The Law of Compensation, with which the Golden Rule works hand in hand, applies to every form of compensation. The advisability of not settling for too little and not grabbing for too much also applies. There is no valid rule of life which stands alone.

Do not think you ever can fake the Golden Rule. It will avail you nothing to *appear* to give what someone else wants, while at heart you are covering up a dishonest and selfish nature. Emerson said:

Human character does evermore publish itself. It will not be concealed . . . it rushes into light . . . I heard an experienced counselor say that he never feared the effect upon a jury of a law-